

SIMPLICIAL ALGORITHM TO COMPUTE THE DEGREE OF A MAP

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1. INTRODUCTION

This is a quick note on how to compute the degree of a map using simplicial methods.

2. DEGREE OF A MAP BETWEEN SPHERES

The notion of degree we defined in the file tree-problem is closely related to the notion of degree of maps between spheres. Basically, the degree of a map from a sphere S^N to itself is the number of times the map goes around the target sphere, up to homotopy. It is clearer to see this on an example: